A-A-2085
June 6, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SIGN
(SELF-ILLUMINATING, EXIT)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This description covers the requirements for signs which designate and provide directions to exit locations. They are provided in two types, as designated:

Type A - single face
Type B - double face

Salient characteristics:

Dimensions. Unless otherwise specified, the exterior dimensions of the signs shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice. The "message face" dimensions shall be as follows (all dimensions are minimum):

Letters - 0.75 inch strokes, 6.0 inches high, 2.50 inches wide (except for the letter "I").

Spacing between letters - 0.50 inches $\pm$ 0.125 inch (spacing between letters shall be uniform).

Background margin surrounding the word "EXIT" - 3/4 inch.

Illumination. Signs shall have a completely self-contained power system which requires no electrical power; illumination shall be the result of activation of a phosphor by the radioactive particle emissions of tritium gas within sealed transparent tubes. The signs will have an average not less than .06 foot lamberts ten years from date of manufacture.

Color. Black, green or red background (face), as specified.

Arrow design. Shall be selected at time of installation.

Candal resistance. The protective casing shall be tamper-resistant. Light sources shall be contained so that the protective casing cannot be opened by unauthorized personnel.

Replacement. Sign shall be accompanied by instructions for its safe replacement and disposal. A permanent marking shall indicate the year the sign is to be replaced.

Conformance. Shall meet all requirements and be licensed by either the Federal Nuclear Regulatory Agency or an "Agreement State" for the manufacture and sale of products containing radioactive material.

Performance testing:

Reflected luminance (brightness). Signs shall be placed in an environment of uniform incident illumination measuring 5.0 foot-candles. The 5.0 foot-candles incident illumination shall be measured and certified with a calibrated cosine-corrected illumination photometer (see Figure 1 for suggested arrangement); following certification of the 5.0 foot-candle incident light, the illumination photometer may be removed. Luminance (brightness) measurements shall be made on the sign faces (letters and background) at the points indicated in Figure 2 ("EXIT" figure). Each point of measurement shall be between 1/4 and 3/8 inch in diameter. The brightness measurements shall be made with a calibrated luminance telephotometer (for measurements made on the colored portions of the sign faces, the luminance telephotometer shall be calibrated in the same color region of the spectrum). The average brightness shall be calculated to determine compliance with the applicable requirements. When tested as specified (a) the average reflected light measurement on the bright portions of the signs (letters) shall equal or exceed 3.0 foot lamberts (b) the average reflected light measurement on the dark portions of the signs (background) shall not exceed 2.0 foot lamberts.

General luminance. Signs shall be placed in environment with no other sources of light (i.e., zero incident illumination). Luminance (brightness) measurements shall be taken on the illuminated portions of the sign face (letters or background) at the points indicated in Figure 2. Each point of measurement shall be between 1/4 and 3/8 inch in diameter. The brightness measurements shall be made with a calibrated luminance telephotometer. When tested as specified, the average measured light on the sign's bright surface shall exceed 0.12 foot lamberts. The minimum measured light at any point on the sign's bright surface shall be no less than 0.08 foot lamberts.

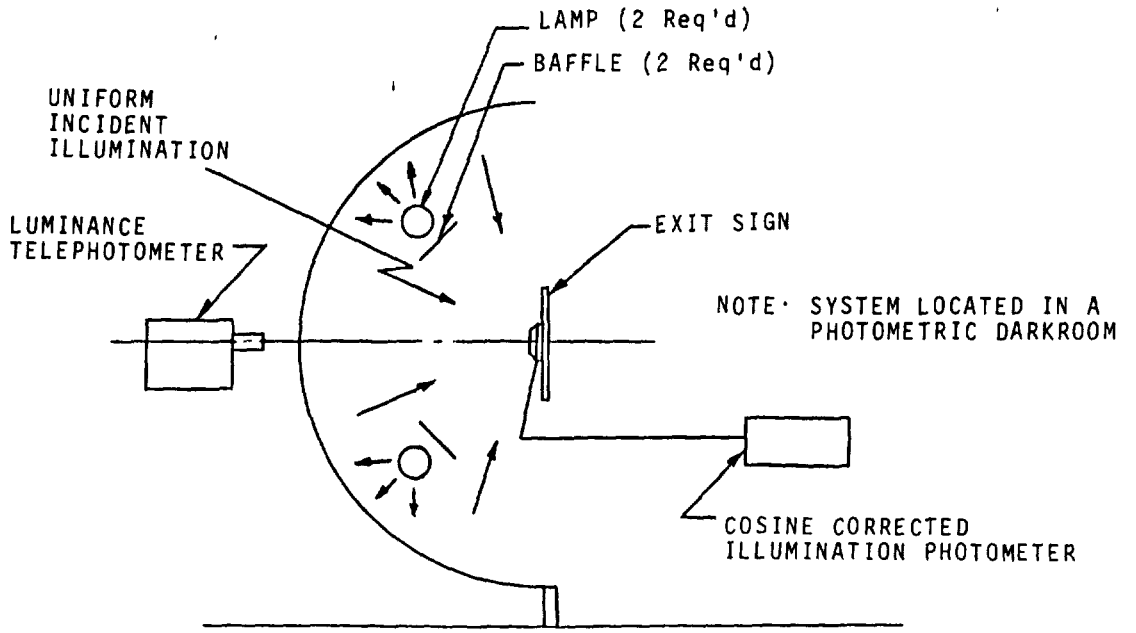
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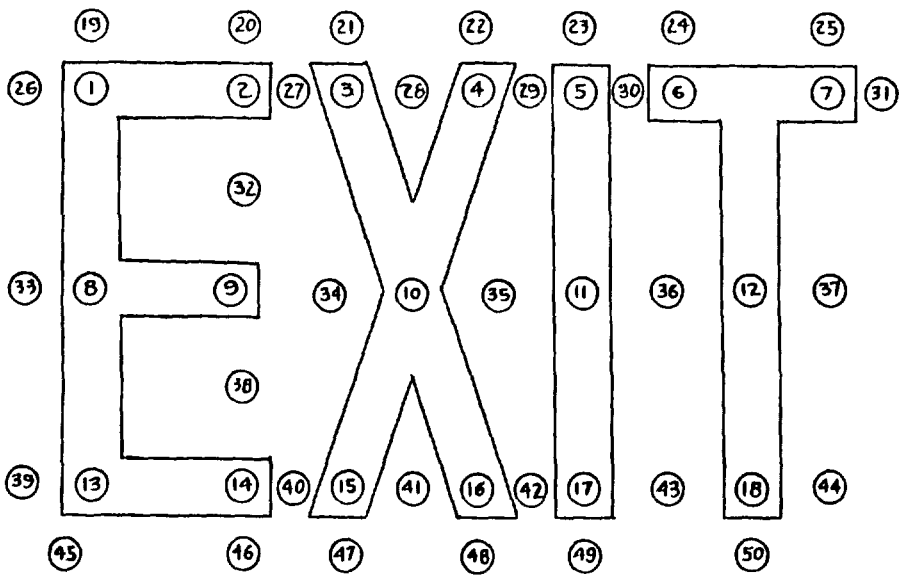
Workmanship. Signs shall be free of rough and sharp edges, slivers, and molding residue. Signs shall be free of defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.



Test Schematic
Figure 1



Luminance (Brightness) Measurement Points
Figure 2

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

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